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NEWSPAPER

28th December, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

52nd WEEK



UN Security Council



SANCTIONS ON NORTH KOREA

UPSC CSE – GS II

**GS II ... IMPORTANT INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTIONS –
STRUCTURE, MANDATE.**



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

28th DECEMBER, 2017

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After the sanctions

Diplomacy remains the best option to bring North Korea to disarmament talks

The fresh round of economic sanctions imposed unanimously by the UN Security Council on North Korea is a predictable response to mounting international frustration over the nuclear stand-off. The measures come days after the U.S., echoing suspicions in other countries, charged the North Korean government with the world-wide 'WannaCry' cyberattacks in May. The sanctions include an 80% curb on refined petroleum imports into North Korea, stringent inspections of ships transferring fuel to the country, and the expulsion of thousands of North Koreans in other countries (who send home crucial hard currency) within two years. Despite the crippling nature of the curbs, there is some good news on this imbroglio. As on previous occasions, Beijing and Moscow were able to impress upon the Security Council the potentially destabilising and hence counterproductive impact of extreme measures. This is significant given the intercontinental ballistic missile that Pyongyang launched in November. It was described by U.S. Defence Secretary Jim Mattis as technically more sophisticated than anything witnessed previously, and the North Korean regime's claim that it could deliver nuclear warheads anywhere in North America has been viewed with concern. However, even as China and Russia approved the latest measures, they continued to state their preference for diplomatic engagement. It remains to be seen how much more pressure Beijing can exert upon Pyongyang.

The stated aim of the sanctions regime has been to force North Korea to halt its nuclear programme and start disarmament negotiations. In September, North Korea detonated its sixth underground nuclear device, which it claimed was a hydrogen bomb. That assertion remains unverified, but experts believe the explosion was many times more powerful than previous detonations. The development has served as a reminder to the U.S. that the scope for military options may be increasingly narrowing. Against this backdrop, a revival of stalled peace negotiations between the P-5 nations and North Korea may be the only realistic alternative on the horizon. The successful conclusion of the 2015 civilian nuclear agreement between the P-5 plus Germany and Iran affords a constructive template to move ahead with North Korea. Certainly, U.S. President Donald Trump has delivered a scathing blow to the Iran deal, even as he stopped short of scrapping it. Iran's continued compliance with the inspections of the International Atomic Energy Agency may not mean much to Mr. Trump, given his overall distrust of multilateral institutions. But that is no reason why other big powers should not pursue the diplomatic effort with redoubled energy. Countries that backed the recently adopted UN nuclear weapons abolition pact should likewise lobby Pyongyang.

3 After the sanctions

Diplomacy remains the best option to bring North Korea to disarmament talks

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MONGOLIA

NORTH KOREA

SOUTH KOREA

CHINA

Yellow Sea

Sea of Japan

North Pacific Ocean

JAPAN

East China Sea





UN Security Council

NEWS REPORT

- UN Security Council unanimously imposed economic sanctions on North Korea.
- There is 89% curbs on refined petroleum imports into North Korea.
- Stringent inspections of ships transferring fuel to the country
- Expulsion of thousands of North Koreans working in other countries with in 2 years.

WHAT THE NORTH KOREA HAS DONE IN RECENT TIMES?

1 SEPTEMBER 2017

- North Korea detonated its sixth underground nuclear device.
- It claimed it as Hydrogen Bomb.
- Explosion is many times more powerful than previous detonations.



However, the world nuclear experts are yet to confirm this as a Hydrogen Bomb.

2 NOVEMBER 2017

- Intercontinental Ballistic Missile (ICBM) was launched in November.
- US admitted that, it is technically more sophisticated than anything witnessed previously.
- North Korea claims that it could deliver nuclear warheads anywhere in North America.
- This is the major cause of concern for the America and the western world

In view of the above 2 developments, military option appears to be the least preferred one.

CAN IRAN NUCLEAR DEAL BE AN EXAMPLE TO SOLVE NORTH KOREA ISSUE?



Recent announcements of America coming out of Iran Nuclear Deal is a major set back.

Countries that backed the recently adopted UN Nuclear Weapons Abolition Pact should lobby with Pyongyang

- 1 After several years of deliberations, P5 + Germany concluded 2015 Civilian Nuclear Agreement with Iran, that can become a constructive template to move ahead with North Korea.
- 2 The revival of the stalled peace negotiations may be the realistic alternative, which appears on the horizon.
- 3 China can play a vital role in bringing North Korea to the negotiating table.
- 4 Other big powers can also pursue diplomatic efforts with redoubled energy.

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